



The Differences Between State and Federal Policymakers

FEDERAL

- » Laws and policies passed by Federal policymakers apply to the entire country.
- » Representatives and Senators meet year-round to vote on laws and policies, with breaks when they go home to their states to hear what people think.
- » Being a U.S. Representative or Senator is usually a full-time job.
- » Staffers for representatives and senators play a very important role, and most offices are made up of many staffers with different roles.

Meeting on the federal level...

- » Meetings are often with staffers, and they are in direct communication with their senator or representative.
- » Members are representing their state, issues should relate to how it benefits or affects the country and their state.

STATE

- » State legislatures pass laws specifically for their state, not the whole country.
- » All states but Nebraska have two houses, like the United States Congress. They may be called different things like Senate, House of Representative, House of Delegates, Assembly and more.
- » State congressional sessions meet only at certain times during the year and for different amounts of time.
- » Every state has different sets of guidelines and a different number of legislators. No two states are the same.
- » Staffers are not as common for state legislators, except in very big states or states where their legislature meets all year (like California).

Meeting on the state level...

- » Meetings are usually with the representative or senator, very few states have staffers for their legislators.
- » Members represent their district, so issues and ideas brought to them should relate to their home district and how it benefits or affects the state and their district.

WHAT IS A...

United States Senator?	• There are two for every state, no matter how many people live in that state. • They represent that state in the United State Congress. • They work on issues that affect the entire country. These are called Federal issues.
United States Representative?	• Each state has a different number of representatives depending on how many people are in that state. • They represent their district in the United States Congress. A district is an area of the state made up of a certain number of people. • They also work on issues that affect the entire country. These are called Federal issues.
State Legislator?	• State legislators represent their district in the state legislature. These districts are different than the ones in the United States Congress. • They only work on issues that affect their state. • Every state has a different number of legislators. They are called different titles in different states (delegate, assemblyman/woman, senator, representative).

**...ALL OF THESE ARE VOTED ON BY YOU
(AND THE PEOPLE THEY REPRESENT)!**